



**MASTERMIND
INDIA**
Spirit of India Special

Prajapati MANSUKHLAL RAGHAVJI, 42

INNOVATION

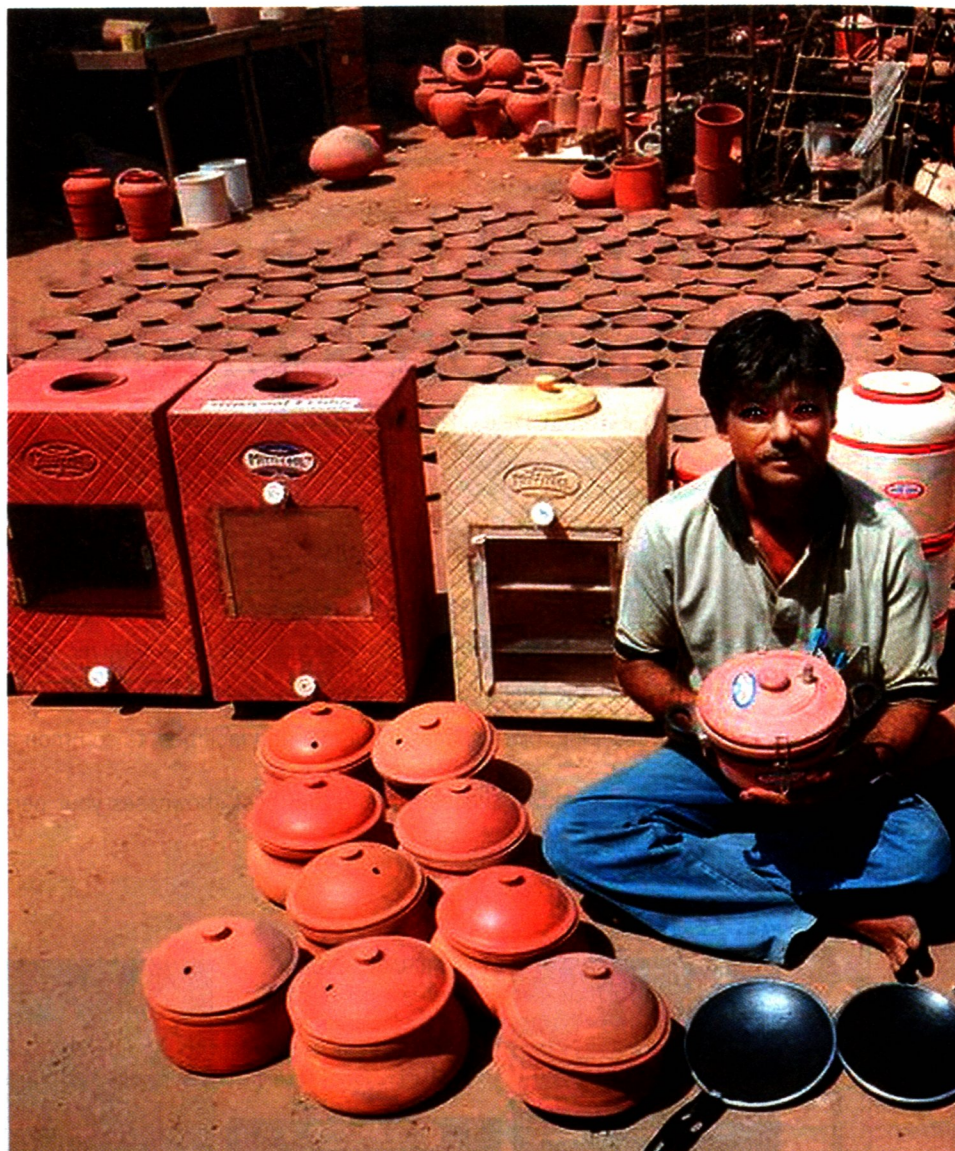
**Modern kitchen
equipment made of clay**

COST

**From Rs 2,000 for a
refrigerator to Rs 50
for a non-stick tawa**

WHAT IT DOES

**The refrigerator cools
naturally without using
any electricity. It is ideal
for rural areas with an
erratic power supply.**



FEAT OF CLAY

By Malini Bhupta

In ancient Hindu mythology, Daksha Prajapati, one of Brahma's sons, created the world from elemental fire, water, wind, earth and air. Legend has it that his descendants, known as the Prajapatis in Gujarat, are making magic using the same five elements. Like Prajapati Mansukhlal RagHAVji, who is redefining his family tradition even as he

carries it forward by creating innovative household products from clay. From refrigerators to water filters, Mansukhlal is making all he can from good old mud.

Born into a potter's family in a village called Nichimandal in Morbi, Mansukhlal knew his destiny lay in clay, but he wasn't content cloning his contemporaries. So he began work as a supervisor in a company manufacturing roof tiles in Gujarat. But he

wasn't happy. Mansukhlal says: "All through this time I felt that different things could be done with clay and I wanted to come up with innovative products using the same material. I wanted to make things that would be simple, convenient and affordable."

The entrepreneur in him compelled Mansukhlal to start his own venture. He took a loan of Rs 30,000 from a money-lender to start an earthenware manufacturing factory in 1988. He purchased a small piece of land for the factory, dyes and presses, soil mixing machine, an electric potter's wheel and some scrap objects. He then modified the roof tile-maker and